into strips. After a few visits to the garden, I became quite an expert myself and could have easily passed off as a planter.

The first year passed by in a flash. The Divisional HQ celebrated its first Raising Day on 1 July 2011. Although we too were raised on the same date, we thought that rather than celebrating the raising day, we would celebrate the completion of raising, the day we became operationally effective, which was 1 October. By then, we had managed to make an Officers' Mess by putting together some re-appropriated shelters, so we could host the GOC, Maj Gen Raman Dhawan and a few planters for lunch. Col Makol was posted out a month or so later, to take over a Brigade in Northern Command. Col Makol was willing to wait for a couple of months more to take over 106 Infantry Brigade itself on my getting posted out and we even took up a case to that effect but it was turned down. We dined out Col Makol and dined in Col Bharat Singh Shekhawat, who was also approved for Brigadier. I thought he was being placed in anticipation of taking over from me. I too got my posting shortly thereafter to the Higher Command Wing of the Army War College, Mhow, and was replaced by Brig Lama. Col Bharat, therefore, would not be staying long in the Brigade, so it was difficult to fathom with what logic these postings were being planned. It was a wonderful, eye-opening experience to raise a new outfit and to know that your name would always be the topmost on the leaderboard.

Veena and Isha continued to stay in the SF at Delhi Cantonment, with Simon a regular visitor. After completing college, Isha wanted to pursue a career in dance through the Danceworx company, which she joined as a trainee dancer. At that time, the company was auditioning for a dance show to be held in the Kingdom of Dreams at Gurgaon. For the auditions and the practices thereafter, Isha would drive to Gurgaon,

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